

When to File a DFW Hail Claim Instead of Paying Out of Pocket

Texas insurance code 28 TAC 21.1006 lets your carrier require roughly 25 percent of your total roof area to show storm-related damage before authorizing a full replacement on a claim (Source: roofraidersandco.com, n.d.). That single threshold explains why two neighbors on the same Plano street can file identical hail claims after the same storm - and one receives a full replacement check while the other gets a spot-repair letter. For Dallas-Fort Worth homeowners with aging 1990s tract-built roofs, knowing whether to file a claim or pay out of pocket comes down to documentation and roof age, not the storm's headline severity.

The short answer: File a claim when your roof carries documented storm damage from a carrier-honored date, is over 18 years old, or sits in the hail belt one storm from total loss - pay out of pocket only for isolated wear unrelated to a covered event. **Who this affects:** Homeowners across Dallas, Tarrant, Collin, and Denton counties, especially those with 1980s-2000s asphalt shingle roofs approaching the end of their lifespan. **What to do:** Get a professional roof inspection that documents damage to the carrier's own language before deciding to file or self-fund a repair. **Timeline:** Before your next policy renewal, and again at your annual inspection.

TC Roofing & Restorations uses AI drone inspection to capture dated, high-resolution photographs of granule loss, soft-metal bruising, and flashing failures that a ground-level look misses - the exact evidence a carrier weighs against that 25 percent threshold.

Is a repair worth the money on an aging DFW roof?

A repair is wasted money when your roof already carries covered storm damage, has outlived its underlayment, or sits one major storm from total loss. Industry guidance identifies three scenarios where a cash repair is bad math: pre-existing storm damage an insurance claim should cover, roofs over 18 years old with multiple repair invoices on file, and hail-belt homes one storm from replacement (Source: roofraidersandco.com, n.d.). Many Richardson and Garland roofs built in the 1980s and 1990s have already weathered multiple hail seasons, thinning granule coverage to the point that a fresh event tips a repairable roof into a full loss. The practical takeaway: before spending on a fall patch, confirm whether a documented claim is the smarter path for a roof already near the end of its service life.

How do I know if a marginal storm actually damaged my roof?

Storm coverage depends on whether the damage is storm-caused rather than pre-existing wear - not on the storm's official risk level. A lower-category storm can still produce hail and gusty winds capable of damaging an aging Tarrant County roof, and insurers evaluate the damage itself, not the Storm Prediction Center rating (Source: tcroofingexperts.com, n.d.). The suburbs along the US-75 corridor - running from McKinney south through Frisco, Plano, and Richardson - sit in DFW's heaviest hail path during the April-through-June peak season. Documenting your roof's condition before a storm makes it far easier to prove new damage came from a specific event, which is why a baseline professional roof inspection protects your ability to file later.

What does the 25 percent damage threshold mean for my claim?

The 25 percent threshold means a carrier can require roughly a quarter of your total roof area to show storm-related damage before approving a full roof replacement rather than a spot repair. This is why documentation determines outcomes: a roof is measured to the carrier's own language, with test-square chalk marks on every slope photographed with a measuring tape in frame, hail strikes counted per 100 square feet, and soft metals like vents, gutter aprons, and ridge caps photographed for impact bruising (Source: [roofraidersandco.com](https://www.roofraidersandco.com), n.d.). For a homeowner in Allen or Wylie whose roof genuinely crossed that threshold, sloppy documentation can still produce a spot-repair letter. The takeaway: insist your contractor cross-references collateral damage on screens, fascia, and gutters - the paperwork, not the storm, decides the payout.

TC Roofing & Restorations provides insurance claim support that documents each slope to the carrier's standard, helping ensure legitimate hail damage repair is measured accurately rather than undercounted.

Which DFW neighborhoods face the highest hail-belt risk?

The highest-risk areas are the mature suburbs where large numbers of roofs share the same age and approach replacement together. The heaviest hail cells run the US-75 corridor, and Texas carriers currently honor claims tied to specific DFW storm dates, including March 2024 and May 2025 events (Source: [roofraidersandco.com](https://www.roofraidersandco.com), n.d.). In Plano and Richardson, established 1980s and 1990s neighborhoods carry roofs that have already survived several hail seasons, leaving thinned granule coverage that a new strike quickly worsens. Frisco, McKinney, and Allen subdivisions built in the 2000s are now hitting the age where asphalt shingles fail under impact - a homeowner working with a roofing contractor in Frisco, TX should ask whether a documented claim from a honored storm date applies. Meanwhile, Denton County and Fort Worth homes on the western edge of the metroplex face wind-driven damage patterns that call for the same baseline documentation.

How do aging shingles interact with a claim decision?

Aging shingles make the difference between a covered claim and a denied one, because deferred maintenance and end-of-life granule loss look like wear rather than storm damage to an adjuster. A roof over 18 years old with multiple repair invoices already on file is patching a roof that has outlived its underlayment (Source: [roofraidersandco.com](https://www.roofraidersandco.com), n.d.). In Carrollton and Mesquite neighborhoods where slab-on-grade brick-veneer homes went up in the same construction wave, entire streets reach shingle failure within a year or two of each other. When your roof does need replacement, TC Roofing & Restorations holds GAF Master Elite certification, which lets us offer factory-backed manufacturer warranties that standard installs cannot match. The takeaway: document your roof's condition now, before wear and storm damage become impossible to separate.

Repair, Claim, or Replace - What Fits Your DFW Roof?

Location & Housing Stock	Roof Situation	What the Data Suggests	Homeowner Action
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Plano / Richardson 1980s-90s tract homes	Thinned granules, multiple hail seasons	One major storm from total loss	File under a honored storm date, not a cash repair
Frisco / McKinney / Allen 2000s subdivisions	Shingles reaching impact-failure age	Approaching replacement together	Baseline inspection now; document per 100 sq ft
Carrollton / Mesquite brick-veneer streets	18+ years, repair invoices on file	Underlayment outlived	Replacement over patching
Fort Worth / Denton County western edge	Wind-driven damage exposure	Same documentation standard applies	Photograph soft metals and fascia
Wylie / Rockwall newer builds, minor wear	Isolated, non-storm damage	Below 25% threshold	Pay out of pocket for spot repair

FAQ

Does the 25 percent damage threshold affect my Collin County claim payout?

Yes - the roughly 25 percent total-roof-area threshold in Texas insurance code 28 TAC 21.1006 directly determines whether your Collin County carrier authorizes a full replacement or a spot repair. Two neighbors on the same Frisco street can file identical claims and get different outcomes based purely on whether documentation met that threshold. The damage must be measured slope by slope, with test squares and hail-strike counts per 100 square feet. Have your roof documented to the carrier's own language before you file.

Should I file a hail claim or just pay for the repair myself in Plano?

File a claim if your Plano roof shows damage from a carrier-honored storm date, is over 18 years old, or sits in the US-75 hail belt one storm from total loss. Pay out of pocket only when the damage is isolated wear unrelated to a covered event. Spending on a fall repair when an insurance-paid replacement is the likely path next spring is bad math. A professional roof inspection settles which route makes financial sense.

What storm dates do Texas insurers currently honor for DFW hail claims?

Texas carriers currently honor claims tied to specific DFW storm dates, including the March 2024 and May 2025 events. If hail from those dates is on your roof, you want a hail damage inspection and a claim rather than a cash repair. Peak hail season runs April through June, with the heaviest cells following the US-75 corridor. Confirm which honored date matches the damage your contractor documents.

My roof is 20 years old - is it too late to file a claim?

It is not automatically too late, but a 20-year-old roof with multiple repair invoices on file is patching a roof that has outlived its underlayment. Adjusters may read end-of-life granule loss as wear rather than storm damage, which is why documentation matters most on older roofs. If a honored storm date produced genuine impact damage, a properly documented claim can still support replacement. Get the condition recorded before wear and storm damage blur together.

How does an AI drone inspection help my insurance claim?

An AI drone inspection produces dated, high-resolution photographs of granule loss, soft-metal bruising, and flashing failures that a ground-level visual inspection misses. That evidence is exactly what a carrier weighs against the 25 percent damage threshold. Capturing hail strikes per 100 square feet and photographing vents, gutter aprons, and ridge caps for impact bruising builds a claim in the insurer's own language. Strong upfront documentation reduces the odds of receiving a spot-repair-only letter.

Can a marginal-risk storm really damage my Tarrant County roof?

Yes - a marginal-risk storm can still produce hail and gusty winds capable of damaging a worn or aging Tarrant County roof. Insurers evaluate the damage itself, not the storm's official category, so coverage depends on whether the damage is storm-caused rather than pre-existing. Older roofs in Fort Worth and surrounding Tarrant County neighborhoods with thinned granules are especially vulnerable to lower-category events. Document your roof's condition before the storm so new damage is easy to separate from prior wear.

Why did my neighbor get a full roof replacement and I only got a repair?

The difference almost always comes down to documentation meeting the roughly 25 percent damage threshold under Texas insurance code, not the storm itself. Two homes on the same Plano or Allen street can file the same claim after the same hail event, and the one whose paperwork proved the threshold gets the replacement check. Test-square chalk marks, tape-in-frame photos, and per-100-square-foot strike counts make or break that outcome. Ask your contractor whether they document to the carrier's language or their own.

What should I do right after hail hits my McKinney home?

Document the roof's condition promptly and schedule a professional roof inspection before deciding anything. In McKinney and the surrounding Collin County hail belt, roofs from the same construction era often reach failure together, so a fresh hail event can push a marginal roof into total loss. Photograph collateral damage on screens, fascia, and gutters, since adjusters cross-reference those against roof-slope evidence. Then confirm whether the hail matches a carrier-honored storm date before you file.

Contact TC Roofing & Restorations for a free inspection.

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